

JOSEPHINE ASHDOWN

Senior Data & Technology Leader | Engineering | Data Platforms | Digital Transformation

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced senior data and technology leader operating across enterprise digital ecosystems, partnering with executive leaders to modernise technology estates, strengthen data governance and enable user-centred, insight-driven decision-making at organisational scale. Proven ability to shape and scale enterprise data delivery operating models, align data to strategy, measure KPIs and deliver measurable business outcomes.

Bridges data engineering, analytics, architecture, governance and security with leadership across the full SDLC, including software engineering, data engineering, analytics, ML and AI capabilities. Strong advocate of product- and outcome-led delivery, embedding Agile and Lean practices that balance speed, scale, quality and compliance. Trusted senior leader to C-suite, programme boards and governance forums, with a track record of building high-performing multidisciplinary teams.

CORE SKILLS

Data Strategy | Data Engineering | Data Platforms | Data Products | Data Governance | Cloud Architecture | Digital Transformation | Engineering Leadership | Operational Leadership | Executive Stakeholder Management | Product-led Delivery | Agile & Lean Delivery | AI & Automation | Roadmaps | OKRs & KPIs | Risk & Governance | Vendor Management | Budget Management

TECHNICAL SKILLS

GCP | AWS | BigQuery | Redshift | Databricks | Microsoft Fabric | Atlan | Unity Catalog | Monte Carlo | dbt | Tableau | Looker | SQL | Python | Scala | ETL/ELT | Real-time and Batch Data | Data Quality | Observability | Data Lineage

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Manager, International Data Technology

Papa Johns | August 2026 - Present

Leading international data technology, platform strategy and data product development across a complex global franchise environment.

- Shape international data strategy, architecture and operating models across multiple markets.
- Define enterprise data products, governance standards, common engineering patterns and modern data architecture.
- Develop scalable API and automated ingestion approaches to improve data availability and consistency.
- Enable analytics, automation, AI and machine learning through secure, governed and reusable data foundations.

Engineering Manager - Data Platform

Compare the Market | April 2025 - July 2026

Led the modernisation and operation of Compare the Market's enterprise data platform, with accountability across platform reliability, governance, data products, engineering standards and transformation.

- Reduced end-to-end data product delivery from around 5 weeks to under 24 hours through platform modernisation, engineering standardisation, improved delivery patterns and AI-enabled engineering practices.
- Introduced patterns supporting sub-5-minute data freshness for business-critical data products.
- Led the transition from Redshift to Databricks, improving scalability, performance and self-service capability.
- Embedded data-as-a-product principles across ingestion, transformation, modelling and consumption.
- Strengthened governance and trust through Atlan, Unity Catalog and Monte Carlo, improving lineage, access control, auditability, observability and data quality.
- Introduced automated documentation, developer experience metrics and AI-supported engineering workflows to improve delivery consistency and speed.
- Balanced strategic transformation with operational ownership of a production enterprise data platform.

Engineering Manager - Data Platform

Sky | January 2023 - May 2025

Led a multidisciplinary data engineering and analytics team supporting personalisation across Sky's global streaming ecosystem, including Peacock, NOW and SST. Accountable for people leadership, engineering delivery, platform reliability and business-critical data products used by Personalisation, Business Intelligence and Decision Science teams.

- Led delivery of large-scale personalisation data capabilities across international streaming platforms.
- Reduced operational risk through improved data quality, incident management, monitoring and proactive reliability practices.
- Oversaw 24/7 support for critical data pipelines and business views during high-demand events including NFL broadcasts and the Paris 2024 Olympics.
- Delivered viewer-impression capabilities across Peacock devices, enabling improved behavioural analysis and model development.
- Led Data Engineering within a major metadata convergence programme, coordinating pipeline and downstream data migrations while protecting historical data and business continuity.
- Built and developed a high-performing team through recruitment, coaching, mentoring and clear accountability.
- Managed complex dependencies across engineering, analytics, product, third-party data providers and senior stakeholders.

Agile Delivery Manager - Commercial

Dunelm | May 2022 - January 2023

Led high-impact digital transformation across commerce and supplier operations, including a greenfield Supplier Portal projected to deliver GBP 5m savings over five years.

- Delivered a new supplier onboarding capability, streamlining commercial operations, reducing duplicated manual effort and improving supplier collaboration and data management.
- Delivered Klarna and PayPal Buy Now, Pay Later capabilities to commercial deadlines, supporting conversion and customer experience.
- Led cross-functional technology and business teams across Product, Engineering and Operations.
- Owned roadmaps, OKRs, prioritisation, delivery governance, risk management and senior stakeholder reporting.

Technology Delivery Manager

TUI | September 2019 - June 2022

Led the Finance Technology domain within TUI's global TRIPS transformation, standardising platforms and business processes across international markets and holiday products.

- Delivered AWS-based, event-driven services supporting global finance transformation.
- Led multidisciplinary teams spanning Product, Architecture, Engineering, DevOps, QA and Business Analysis.
- Owned roadmaps, PI planning, prioritisation, vendor relationships, budgets, risk and executive stakeholder management.
- Coordinated complex dependencies across markets, suppliers and technology teams to deliver end-to-end transformation.

EARLIER CAREER

Project Manager / Business Analyst

BSH Home Appliances Group | April 2017 - September 2019

- Led operational service management and transformation initiatives across Bosch, Siemens, Neff and Gaggenau aftersales operations.
- Managed suppliers, SLAs, service performance and continuous improvement; delivered the UK Consumer Extended Warranty launch and outsourced payments capability.
- Introduced digital tooling supporting field-engineer replacement processes and customer retention.

Key Account and Operations Manager

Servest SA | January 2015 - March 2017

- Managed key accounts and nationwide field operations for the security division, with accountability for client relationships, SLAs, service performance and operational delivery.
- Coordinated nationwide field engineering operations including scheduling, performance, training, HR and fleet management.
- Tracked KPIs and financial performance and introduced continuous improvement across maintenance, audits, inspections and operational workflows.

SQL Database Developer/Engineer | CRM & Data Management

Thames Valley Air Ambulance | January 2012 - January 2015 | Part-time

- Managed SQL databases, CRM systems and data processes supporting fundraising and operational activities.
- Developed SQL queries, reports and data processes supporting lottery players, direct debits, payments and operational reporting.
- Managed the relationship with an external IT provider and used data and reporting to support finance, fundraising and operational decision-making.

Operations Support Manager

Chiltern Dial a Ride | December 2008 - January 2015 | Part-time

- Led the operational integration of two regional Dial a Ride services, integrating routes, customers, staff, vehicles, databases and supporting technology while maintaining service continuity.

- Managed 8 salaried drivers and 20 volunteers across scheduling, payroll, leave, training and performance.
- Conducted customer research which informed service improvements and contributed to securing GBP 50,000 in funding; improved efficiency through route optimisation and process redesign.

Information Technology Internship

GE Healthcare | June 2013 - September 2013

Summer internship supporting Information Technology.

Information Technology Internship

Whitbread | May 2012 - September 2012

Summer internship within the Information Technology function in Dunstable, Bedfordshire.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science and AI Engineering - Currently studying

PGDip Digital Technology Solutions - Manchester Metropolitan University

BSc Information Technology Management for Business - University of Hertfordshire

CERTIFICATIONS

CMI Level 5 Diploma in Management & Leadership | SAFe Agilist | Certified Scrum Master | AgilePM Practitioner | PRINCE2 | ITIL v4 | Kanban | Change Management Practitioner

VOLUNTEERING

MK Play Association - Trustee / Interim CEO

Supported charity governance, organisational leadership, service continuity and community-focused delivery.